Delegated Financial Authority

Harbour Health. Owner: Fatima Ali, Finance Officer. Approved by the Board on 24 March 2026. Effective from 1 April 2026 for the 2026/27 financial year (1 April 2026 to 31 March 2027).

This document sets who can commit Harbour to spending money, and up to what value. It applies to purchase orders, contracts, expenses and payments. The Procurement Process in the Operations folder sets how many quotes are needed; this document sets who approves.

1. Purchase and contract approval limits

Limits are per order or per contract, excluding VAT, over the whole life of the contract.

Role	Holder	Limit
Clinic manager	Each clinic's manager	Up to £1,000, within their clinic budget
Procurement Lead	George Evans	Up to £4,999
Operations Director	Nina Osei	Up to £24,999
Board	Board of Harbour Health	£25,000 and above, at its monthly meeting, or by the Chair between meetings if it cannot wait

Nobody can approve a purchase they requested themselves, or one where they have declared a personal link to the supplier. It goes to the next level up.

2. Expenses

Claim	Approver
Any claim	The claimant's line manager
Claims over £250	Also the Operations Director
The Operations Director's own claims	Finance Officer

The limits for meals, hotels and mileage are in the Travel and Expenses Policy in the Policies folder.

3. Payments

- Finance runs supplier payment batches on Tuesdays and Fridays.
- Every payment batch needs two people: Fatima Ali prepares it and Nina Osei releases it in the bank portal.
- A single payment over £10,000 needs both of them to check the invoice and the PO, not just the batch total.
- Urgent payments outside the batch days need the Operations Director's approval by email.
- Payroll is prepared by Finance and released by the Operations Director on the 25th of each month, or the last working day before.

4. Budgets

- Each clinic manager holds a budget for consumables, small repairs and local purchases. Budgets are set in March for the financial year.
- Overspends of more than 10% of a clinic's quarterly budget must be explained to the Operations Director within 10 working days of the quarter end.
- Moving money between clinic budgets needs the Operations Director's approval.

5. Write-offs and refunds

Value	Approver
Up to £499	Finance Officer
£500 to £4,999	Operations Director
£5,000 and above	Board

6. Breaches

Committing Harbour to spending above your limit, or splitting an order to stay within it, is a disciplinary matter. Suppliers are told that Harbour is only bound by orders with a valid PO number.

7. Review

Fatima Ali reviews these limits every year in January, and the Board approves them in March.